



HUDA BEAUTY

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INTRODUCTION

Huda Beauty is Huda Kattan's makeup brand, founded in 2013 and taking off globally in 2015. It has become the face of influencer marketing in the beauty industry and has stood on the founder-centric principle that Huda is the brand.



KEY PUBLICS

Influencers

- Influencer collective comprised of ~500 top-tier creators
- Advocate for the brand
- Participate in product curation and representative marketing

Gen Z Makeup Enthusiasts

- Hold the beauty industry to a high ethical standard
- Rely on influencer testing with real results

Retailers - Sephora

- Exclusive North American retailer
- Pressured by both sides of crises to continue or exit Huda Beauty's products



COMMUNICATIONS CHALLENGES AND REPUTATIONAL THREATS

- **Accusations of IP theft** from Beauty Bakerie concerning Huda Beauty's Easy Bake Loose Baking & Setting Powder
- **Partnering with Huda Mustafa**, dropped the partnership after Mustafa laughed at a racial slur directed toward Olandria Carthen
- Outspoken on supporting the Palestinian people, donating over \$1m for humanitarian aid, and making **controversial comments on Israel's role in several geopolitical events**, leading to calls for the removal of her products from retailers
- **Made a misinformed repost** of a pro-Iranian government protester, deleted the post and clarified her stance

GOALS / RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Moving from risky reposts to offering support to those who need it
- Research is emparative in the future



MESSAGE MAP



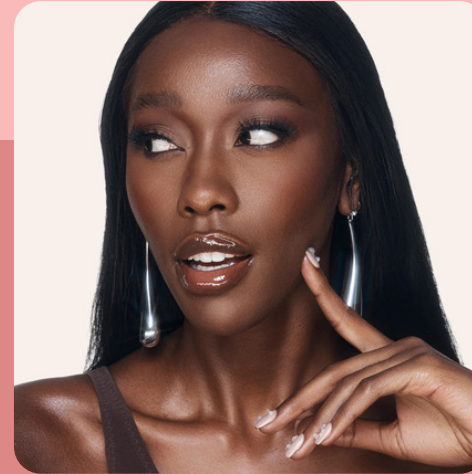
Gen Z Consumers & Global “Glam” Audience

Core Message 1: Our values only mean something if our actions back them up, and we're committed to making sure they do.

Secondary Message: We're done making promises without proof. Every commitment we make will come with a clear record of how we followed through.

Core Message 2: Beauty is still at the heart of everything we do, and it always will be.

Secondary Message: Huda Beauty was built on artistry, self-expression, and the belief that beauty belongs to everyone. That hasn't changed.



Influencers, MUAs & “Glam Collective”

Core Message 1: Your artistry built this brand. We're here to invest in you, not just feature you.

Secondary Message: Huda Beauty's relationship with creators has always been collaborative. We're deepening that commitment, with a particular focus on the voices that have historically been overlooked.

Core Message 2: When you partner with Huda Beauty, your reputation is protected, not put at risk.

Secondary Message: We recognize that past missteps reflected on the creators who stood alongside us. That ends here, with clearer standards applied before any partnership goes public.



Retail Partners & Investors

Core Message 1: We have identified the vulnerabilities in our communication model — and we've built structure around them.

Secondary Message: Founder-led brands carry inherent risk. We are not eliminating Huda Kattan's voice, we are ensuring it is supported by systems that protect the business when her convictions put it in the public eye.

Core Message 2: The business fundamentals are strong, and the steps we're taking now are designed to keep them that way.

Secondary Message: Reputational turbulence has not eroded our market position. We're reinforcing our foundation so that future controversies do not become commercial liabilities.



STRATEGY

- Social Media and Culture/Beauty Reporters
 - Highlight changes and credibility
- Be more transparent moving forward
- Authentically showcase the diverse creators we work with
- Show we are following through on our promises/public statements



TACTICS

1. Pitch - dropping Huda Mustafa
2. Press release - platforming and partnership initiatives
3. Video storytelling- denouncing Huda Mustafa's actions
4. Expand influencer marketing team for better research
5. **Social listening**
6. Pitch - WWD Beauty, control the narrative
7. **Donation to Palestinian aid on next product launch**
8. Social media links
9. Press release - earnings and donations
10. Pitch - makeup industry's responsibility to support human rights
11. Introduce partnerships with voices who can speak on specialties within Huda Beauty's product lines
12. **Press release - implementing a CSR board**
13. Reorganize website to show priorities
14. Brand ambassador program specifically for Middle Eastern creators
15. Monthly community events to make care packages for those affected by war

TACTICS CONTINUED



Donations

- Allocate a percentage of proceeds from the next major product launch to Palestinian aid
- Communicate this to the public through pitching to WWD, reorganizing the website and promoting on social media
- Aligns financial actions with our founder's values, building consumer trust and brand credibility



CSR board

- By having a team specifically dedicated to CSR, it will show that Huda Beauty hears the concerns and is making this a priority. They are putting in effort to make sure that they do not face similar challenges in the future. It also may be good to have other voices to collaborate with Huda so she has more people advising her on what to say.
- Push this out with a press release



Social listening

- Use social listening tools like Hootsuite or Meltwater to monitor real-time brand sentiment
- Dedicate a team member specifically to tracking and analyzing online conversations
- Identify potential issues early before they escalate into larger PR crises
- Helps us stay proactive

THANK YOU

